

OMB Control No: 0970-0114

Expiration date: 03/31/2027

THE PAPERWORK REDUCTION ACT OF 1995 (Pub. L. 104–13)

The purpose of this information collection is the application for CCDF funds and provides ACF and the public with a description of, and assurance about, the States' and Territories' child care programs. Public reporting burden for this collection of information is estimated to average 150 hours per response, including the time for reviewing instructions, gathering, and maintaining the data needed, and completing the form. This is a mandatory collection of information (Pub. L. 113–186), and 42 U.S.C. 9858.

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**Appendix 1: Lead Agency Implementation Plan
for**

State/Territory Iowa

FFY 2025 – 2027

Version: Initial Plan

Plan Status: Approved as of 2024-11-09 00:55:03 GMT

For each non-compliance, Lead Agencies must describe the following:

- **Action Steps:** List the action steps needed to correct the finding (e.g., update policy manual, legislative approval, IT system changes, etc.). For each action step list the:
 - o **Expected Completion Date:** List the expected completion date for the action step.
- **Overall Target Date for Compliance:** List date Lead Agency anticipates completing implementation, achieving full compliance with all aspects of the findings. (Note: Compliance will not be determined until the FFY 2025-2027 CCDF Plan is amended and approved).

EQUAL ACCESS:AFFORDABILITY

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not provide data on the extent to which CCDF providers charge families additional amounts above the required co-payment (including data on the size and frequency of such amounts), as required by 98.45(b)(5). (Plan Question 3.1.2eii)

Overall Target Completion Date: 08/01/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Finalize requirements around capturing this data element and reports for this data into development of new subsidy IT System.	02/01/2025
2	Execute contract for development of new subsidy system.	03/01/2025
3	Development and initial user acceptance testing of new subsidy IT system by contractor.	06/01/2026
4	Final user acceptance testing of new subsidy IT system.	07/01/2026
5	Roll out of new subsidy IT system.	08/01/2026

EQUAL ACCESS:PAYMENT PRACTICES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not pay all provider types prospectively or alternatively does not demonstrate that it is not a generally-accepted practice for all provider types, as required by 98.45(m)(1). (Plan Question 4.4.1a). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through August 1, 2026.
- The Lead Agency does not pay based on enrollment or alternatively does not provide justification that this is impracticable or is not a generally-accepted practice, as required by 98.45(m)(2). (Plan Question 4.4.1b). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through August 1, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 08/01/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Finalize requirements for functionality of prospective payment and pay by enrollment for development of new subsidy IT system.	02/01/2025
2	Execute contract for development of new subsidy system.	03/01/2025
3	Development and initial user acceptance testing of new subsidy IT system by contractor.	06/01/2026
4	Final user acceptance testing of new subsidy IT system.	07/01/2026
5	Revise Iowa Administrative Code for Child Care Assistance program to reflect prospective payment and pay by enrollment.	08/01/2026
6	Roll out new subsidy IT system.	08/01/2026

EQUAL ACCESS:PROVIDER OPTIONS FOR PARENTS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not provide grants or contracts for direct services for infants and toddlers, for children in underserved geographic areas, and for children with disabilities, as required by 98.30(b)(1). (Plan Questions 4.1.1c and 4.5.1i). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through August 1, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 07/01/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Analyze Iowa Child Care Connect (C3) data to identify underserved geographic areas and areas where there is significant lack of services for infants and toddlers.	04/01/2025
2	Convene the following focus groups regarding barriers to child care for children with disabilities: Families that have children with disabilities	06/01/2025

	Providers that serve children with disabilities Partner organizations that support children with disabilities	
3	Follow state procurement processes to develop and release a Request for Proposal (RFP) and award contracts for direct services.	10/01/2025
4	Finalize and start contracts for direct services for infants and toddlers, children in underserved geographic areas and children with disabilities	07/01/2026

HEALTH AND SAFETY:BUILDING AND PHYSICAL PREMISES SAFETY

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency has not established a standard for building and physical premises safety, including the identification of and protection from hazards, bodies of water, and vehicular traffic for licensed centers, as required by 98.41(a)(1)(v). (Plan Questions 5.3.5ai, 5.3.5bi, and 5.3.5ci)
- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed centers for compliance with a standard for building and physical premises safety, including the identification of and protection from hazards, bodies of water, and vehicular traffic, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B). (Plan Question 5.5.1aii)

Overall Target Completion Date: 07/01/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Draft new language for Iowa Administrative Code (Chapter 441.109) to include safety standards for identification and protection from bodies of water and vehicular traffic.	10/01/2024
2	Finalize Iowa Administrative Code (Chapter 441.109) for licensed centers to include a safety standard for identification and protection from bodies of water and vehicular traffic.	07/01/2025
3	Update Child Care Center Licensing Standards and Procedures document (COMM 204) to remove the term recommendation and provide	07/01/2025

	clarified guidance to child care center staff regarding licensing standards.	
4	Update compliance checklist used by licensing inspectors to reflect the updated licensing standards in Iowa Administrative Code (Chapter 441.109)	07/01/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:CHILD DEVELOPMENT

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not require pre-service or orientation training on child development for licensed centers, as required by 98.44(b)(1)(iii). (Plan Question 5.4.1I)
- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed centers for compliance with pre-service or orientation requirements related to child development, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B). (Plan Question 5.5.1aII)

Overall Target Completion Date: 07/01/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Draft new language for Iowa Administrative Code (Chapter 441.109) which clarifies that Essentials is the required pre-service training. Essentials has been reviewed and found to meet this requirement.	10/01/2024
2	Finalize Iowa Administrative Code (Chapter 441.109) for licensed centers to include Essentials as the required pre-service training.	07/01/2025
3	Update Child Care Center Licensing Standards and Procedures document (COMM 204) to remove the term recommendation and provide clarified guidance to child care center staff regarding licensing standards.	07/01/2025
4	Update compliance checklist used by licensing inspectors to reflect the updated licensing standards in Iowa Administrative Code (Chapter 441.109) .	07/01/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS AND RESPONSE PLANNING

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not require pre-service or orientation training on emergency preparedness and response planning for licensed centers, as required by 98.44(b)(1)(i). (Plan Question 5.4.1g)
- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed centers for compliance with pre-service or orientation requirements related to emergency preparedness and response planning, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B). (Plan Question 5.5.1aii)

Overall Target Completion Date: 07/01/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Draft new language for Iowa Administrative Code (Chapter 441.109) which clarifies that Essentials is the required pre-service training. Essentials has been reviewed and found to meet this requirement.	10/01/2024
2	Finalize Iowa Administrative Code (Chapter 441.109) for licensed centers to include Essentials as the required pre-service training.	07/01/2025
3	Update Child Care Center Licensing Standards and Procedures document (COMM 204) to remove the term recommendation and provide clarified guidance to child care center staff regarding licensing standards.	07/01/2025
4	Update compliance checklist used by licensing inspectors to reflect the updated licensing standards in Iowa Administrative Code (Chapter 441.109)	07/01/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:HANDLING AND STORAGE OF HAZARDOUS MATERIALS AND DISPOSAL OF BIOCONTAMINANTS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency has not established a standard for the handling and storage of hazardous materials for licensed centers, as required by 98.41(a)(1)(viii). (Plan Question 5.3.8ai)
- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed centers for compliance with a standard for handling and storage of hazardous materials, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B). (Plan Question 5.5.1aii)

Overall Target Completion Date: 07/01/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Draft new language for Iowa Administrative Code (Chapter 441.109) to include standards for handling and storage of hazardous materials and disposal of biocontaminants.	10/01/2024
2	Finalize Iowa Administrative Code (Chapter 441.109) for licensed centers to include standards for handling and storage of hazardous materials and disposal of biocontaminants.	07/01/2025
3	Update Child Care Center Licensing Standards and Procedures document (COMM 204) to remove the term recommendation and provide clarified guidance to child care center staff regarding licensing standards.	07/01/2025
4	Update compliance checklist used by licensing inspectors to reflect the updated licensing standards in Iowa Administrative Code (Chapter 441.109)	07/01/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:ONGOING TRAINING

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed family child care providers or an annual inspection for license-exempt family child care providers for compliance with ongoing training requirements, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B) and 98.42(b)(2)(ii). (Plan Questions 5.5.1.bii and 5.5.2bi)

Overall Target Completion Date: 07/01/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Draft new language for Iowa Administrative Code which updates ongoing training requirements for licensed family child care providers and licensed-exempt family child care providers from biennial to annual.	10/01/2025
2	Finalize Iowa Administrative Code to updated standards to annual ongoing training requirements.	07/01/2026
3	Update Standards and Procedure documents for licensed family child care (COMM 143) and licensed-exempt family child care (COMM 95) to reflect the updated annual ongoing training requirements.	07/01/2026
4	Update compliance checklist used by licensing inspectors to reflect the updated standards for licensed family child care and license-exempt family child care.	07/01/2026

HEALTH AND SAFETY:PEDIATRIC FIRST AID AND PEDIATRIC CPR

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency has not established a standard for pediatric first aid for all staff in licensed family child care homes or license-exempt family child care homes, as required by 98.41(a)(1)(x). (Plan Questions 5.3.10aii and 5.3.10av)
- The Lead Agency does not require pre-service or orientation training on pediatric first aid for licensed family child care homes or license-exempt family child care homes, as required by 98.44(b)(1)(i). (Plan Question 5.4.1j)
- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed family child care providers or an annual inspection for license-exempt family child care providers for compliance with a standard for pediatric first aid and with related pre-service or orientation training requirements, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B) and 98.42(b)(2)(ii). (Plan Questions 5.5.1bii and 5.5.2bi)

Overall Target Completion Date: 07/01/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Draft new language for Iowa Administrative Code which updates first aid requirements for licensed family child care providers and licensed-exempt family child care providers to include that it must be pediatric.	10/01/2025
2	Finalize Iowa Administrative Code to updated standards to pediatric first aid.	07/01/2026
3	Update Standards and Procedure documents for licensed family child care (COMM 143) and licensed-exempt family child care (COMM 95) to reflect the pediatric first aid standard.	07/01/2026
4	Update compliance checklist used by licensing inspectors to reflect the updated standards for licensed family child care and license-exempt family child care.	07/01/2026
5	Update Essentials pre-service training to reflect the pediatric first aid standard for licensed family child care and license-exempt family child care.	07/01/2026

HEALTH AND SAFETY:POSTING INSPECTION REPORTS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not post full monitoring and inspection reports that include all areas of compliance and non-compliance for all licensed centers, licensed family child care providers, license-exempt family child care providers, or out-of-school programs, as required by 98.33(a)(4)(ii). (Plan Question 5.5.4aii). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for portions of this requirement through August 1, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 07/01/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Develop service request language to submit for changes to current IT system which generates compliance reports.	10/01/2024

2	Completion of IT system updates for licensed center reports. Date aligns with effective date of updated Iowa Administrative Code.	07/01/2025
3	Completion of IT system updates for licensed family child care and license-exempt family child care reports. Date aligns with effective date of updated Iowa Administrative Code.	07/01/2026

HEALTH AND SAFETY:PREVENTION OF SHAKEN BABY SYNDROME, ABUSIVE HEAD TRAUMA, AND CHILD MALTREATMENT

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not require pre-service or orientation training on prevention of child maltreatment for licensed centers, as required by 98.44(b)(1)(i). (Plan Question 5.4.1f)
- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed centers for compliance with pre-service or orientation training requirements related to the prevention of child maltreatment, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B). (Plan Question 5.5.1aii)

Overall Target Completion Date: 07/01/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Draft new language for Iowa Administrative Code (Chapter 441.109) which clarifies that Essentials is the required pre-service training. Essentials has been reviewed and found to meet this requirement.	10/01/2024
2	Finalize Iowa Administrative Code (Chapter 441.109) for licensed centers to include Essentials as the required pre-service training.	07/01/2025
3	Update Child Care Center Licensing Standards and Procedures document (COMM 204) to remove the term recommendation and provide clarified guidance to child care center staff regarding licensing standards.	07/01/2025

4	Update compliance checklist used by licensing inspectors to reflect the updated licensing standards in Iowa Administrative Code (Chapter 441.109)	07/01/2025
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COMPREHENSIVE BACKGROUND CHECK:5 YEAR RENEWAL

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not conduct all background checks every 5 years, as required by 98.43(d)(2)(ii). (Plan Question 5.7.17)

Overall Target Completion Date: 07/01/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Child Care Policy Team informed the Lead Agency's Human Resources staff of changes needed to current background check operations for child care facilities and provided necessary legal information	11/01/2024
2	The Lead Agency's Division of Compliance, Bureau of Human Resources will develop policies for completion of background checks.	02/01/2025
3	The Child Care Policy Team will convene a workgroup to discuss implementation changes needed with licensed child care center directors to assess change impact.	07/01/2025
4	Based on the developed policy, the Lead Agency's Child Care Policy Team will work with the Human Resources Team on identifying required background checks and the parties that must be background checked.	09/01/2025
5	Lead Agency staffing needs to complete background checks will be determined based on assumptions of current numbers of completed record checks each year.	10/01/2025

6	Legislative action will be requested in January 2026 to modify Iowa Code 237A to change processes for completion of record checks.	01/31/2026
7	A communication plan will be developed, specific to provider type (center vs. family child care) that provides guidance for child care providers on the change in process to background checks being run through the Lead Agency's Human Resources department.	06/01/2026
8	An IT system enhancement will be developed to track and monitor results of background checks and clearance for child care employment.	07/01/2026

COMPREHENSIVE BACKGROUND CHECK:BACKGROUND CHECK PROCESSES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency or other state agency is not the entity conducting all required background checks and does not ensure the privacy of the background check results, as required by 98.43(a)(1)(i) and 98.43(e)(2). (Plan Question 5.7.10)
- The Lead Agency does not ensure that child care staff that reside in a different State receive a comprehensive background check, as required by 98.43(e)(1) and 98.43(a)(1). (Plan Question 5.7.13b)
- The Lead Agency does not conduct background checks when a provider is separated from employment for more than 180 consecutive days, as required by 98.43(d)(3)(iii). (Plan Question 5.7.17)

Overall Target Completion Date: 07/01/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Child Care Policy Team informed Lead Agency Human Resources staff of changes needed to current background check operations for child care facilities and provide necessary legal information	11/01/2024
2	The Lead Agency's Division of Compliance, Bureau of Human Resources will develop policies for completion of background checks.	02/01/2025

3	The Child Care Policy Team will convene a workgroup to discuss implementation changes needed with licensed child care center directors to assess change impact	07/01/2025
4	Based on the developed policy, the Lead Agency's Child Care Policy Team will work with the Human Resources Team on identifying required background checks and the parties that must be background checked.	09/01/2025
5	Lead Agency staffing needs to complete background checks will be determined based on assumptions of current numbers of completed record checks each year.	10/01/2025
6	Legislative action will be requested in January 2026 to modify Iowa Code 237A to change processes for completion of record checks.	01/31/2026
7	A communication plan will be developed, specific to provider type (center vs. family child care) that provides guidance for child care providers on the change in process to background checks being run through the Lead Agency's Human Resources department.	06/01/2026
8	An IT system enhancement will be developed to track and monitor results of background checks and clearance for child care employment.	07/01/2026

COMPREHENSIVE BACKGROUND CHECK:NATIONAL NAME-BASED

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not require and conduct NCIC NSOR name-based background checks for all child care staff members (including prospective staff members), as required by 98.43(b)(2), 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B), and 98.43(a). (Plan Questions 5.7.3a and 5.7.3b)
- The Lead Agency does not require and conduct NCIC NSOR name-based checks for all individuals age 18 or older who reside in a family child care home, as required by 98.43(b)(2), 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B), and 98.43(a). (Plan Question 5.7.3c)

Overall Target Completion Date: 07/01/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Child Care Policy Team informed Lead Agency Human Resources staff of changes needed to current background check operations for child care facilities and provide necessary legal information	11/01/2024
2	The Lead Agency's Division of Compliance, Bureau of Human Resources will develop policies for completion of background checks.	02/01/2025
3	The Child Care Policy Team will convene a workgroup to discuss implementation changes needed with licensed child care center directors to assess change impact.	07/01/2025
4	Based on the developed policy, the Lead Agency's Child Care Policy Team will work with the Human Resources Team on identifying required background checks and the parties that must be background checked.	09/01/2025
5	Lead Agency staffing needs to complete background checks will be determined based on assumptions of current numbers of completed record checks each year.	10/01/2025
6	Legislative action will be requested in January 2026 to modify Iowa Code 237A to change processes for completion of record checks.	01/31/2026
7	A communication plan will be developed, specific to provider type (center vs. family child care) that provides guidance for child care providers on the change in process to background checks being run through the Lead Agency's Human Resources department.	06/01/2026
8	An IT system enhancement will be developed to track and monitor results of background checks and clearance for child care employment.	07/01/2026

COMPREHENSIVE BACKGROUND CHECK:INTER-STATE

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not require and conduct interstate criminal history background checks for all staff members (or prospective staff members) who resided in other state(s) in the past 5 years, as required by 98.43(b)(3)(i)(B), 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B), and 98.43(a). (Plan Questions 5.7.6a and 5.7.6b)
- The Lead Agency does not require and conduct interstate criminal history background checks for all individuals age 18 or older who reside in a family child care home and resided in other state(s) in the past 5 years, as required by 98.43(b)(3)(i)(B), 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B), and 98.43(a). (Plan Question 5.7.6c)
- The Lead Agency does not require and conduct interstate sex offender registry checks for all staff members (or prospective staff members) who resided in other state(s) in the past 5 years, as required by 98.43(b)(3)(ii), 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B), and 98.43(a). (Plan Questions 5.7.7a and 5.7.7b)
- The Lead Agency does not require and conduct interstate sex offender registry checks for all individuals age 18 or older who reside in a family child care home and resided in other state(s) in the past 5 years, as required by 98.43(b)(3)(ii), 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B), and 98.43(a). (Plan Question 5.7.7c)
- The Lead Agency does not require and conduct interstate CAN registry checks for all staff members (or prospective staff members) who resided in other state(s) in the past 5 years eligible for CCDF participation, as required by 98.43(b)(3)(iii), 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B), and 98.43(a). (Plan Questions 5.7.8a and 5.7.8b)
- The Lead Agency does not require and conduct the interstate CAN registry checks for all individuals age 18 or older who resided in other state(s) in the past 5 years who reside in a family child care home, as required by 98.43(b)(3)(iii), 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B), and 98.43(a). (Plan Question 5.7.8c)

Overall Target Completion Date: 07/01/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Child Care Policy Team informed Lead Agency Human Resources staff of changes needed to current background check operations for child care facilities and provide necessary legal information	11/01/2024
2	The Lead Agency's Division of Compliance, Bureau of Human Resources will develop policies for completion of background checks.	02/01/2025
3	The Child Care Policy Team will convene a workgroup to discuss implementation changes needed with licensed child care center directors to assess change impact.	07/01/2025

4	Based on the developed policy, the Lead Agency's Child Care Policy Team will work with the Human Resources Team on identifying required background checks and the parties that must be background checked.	09/01/2025
5	Lead Agency staffing needs to complete background checks will be determined based on assumptions of current numbers of completed record checks each year.	10/01/2025
6	Legislative action will be requested in January 2026 to modify Iowa Code 237A to change processes for completion of record checks.	01/31/2026
7	A communication plan will be developed, specific to provider type (center vs. family child care) that provides guidance for child care providers on the change in process to background checks being run through the Lead Agency's Human Resources department.	06/01/2026
8	An IT system enhancement will be developed to track and monitor results of background checks and clearance for child care employment.	07/01/2026

COMPREHENSIVE BACKGROUND CHECK:PRE-SERVICE CHECK REQUIREMENTS (PROVISIONAL HIRE)

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not require a qualifying result from an FBI criminal background check or an in-state criminal background check with fingerprints before a prospective staff member begins work, as required by 98.43(d)(4). (Plan Questions 5.7.12a and 5.7.12b)
- The Lead Agency allows the prospective staff member to work unsupervised before receiving a qualifying result on the comprehensive background check requirements, as required by 98.43(d)(4). (Plan Question 5.7.12i)

Overall Target Completion Date: 07/01/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Child Care Policy Team informed Lead Agency Human Resources staff of changes needed to current background check operations for child care facilities and provide necessary legal information	11/01/2024
2	The Lead Agency's Division of Compliance, Bureau of Human Resources will develop policies for completion of background checks.	02/01/2025
3	The Child Care Policy Team will convene a workgroup to discuss implementation changes needed with licensed child care center directors to assess change impact.	07/01/2025
4	Based on the developed policy, the Lead Agency's Child Care Policy Team will work with the Human Resources Team on identifying required background checks and the parties that must be background checked.	09/01/2025
5	Lead Agency staffing needs to complete background checks will be determined based on assumptions of current numbers of completed record checks each year.	10/01/2025
6	Legislative action will be requested in January 2026 to modify Iowa Code 237A to change processes for completion of record checks.	01/31/2026
7	A communication plan will be developed, specific to provider type (center vs. family child care) that provides guidance for child care providers on the change in process to background checks being run through the Lead Agency's Human Resources department.	06/01/2026
8	An IT system enhancement will be developed to track and monitor results of background checks and clearance for child care employment.	07/01/2026

PROGRAM INTEGRITY: EFFECTIVE INTERNAL CONTROLS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not describe processes to train providers about program requirements and integrity, as required by 98.68(a)(3). (Plan Question 10.1.5bi)

Overall Target Completion Date: 08/01/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	CCA Program Manager develops outline of required concepts and content for the provider training. Outline must align with new payment policies and functionality of new IT subsidy system.	04/01/2026
2	Lead Agency Child Care leadership will review content to determine if training will be developed internally or externally.	05/01/2026
3	Launch provider training with the launch of new subsidy IT system	08/01/2026

PROGRAM INTEGRITY:FRAUD INVESTIGATION, PAYMENT RECOVERY, AND SANCTIONS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not impose sanctions on clients in response to fraud, as required by 98.68(b)(2). (Plan Question 10.2.2e)

Overall Target Completion Date: 07/01/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Lead Agency's legal counsel will review Iowa Administrative Rules 441. Chapter 7: Appeals and Hearings and related Iowa Code as well as current sanctions for child care providers to make recommendations for client sanctions.	08/01/2025

2	The Lead Agency will complete a pre-file to make recommendations for legislative action regarding changes needed in Iowa Code to implement client sanctions.	01/31/2026
3	Implement new Iowa Administrative Rules related to client sanctions based on Iowa Code change.	07/01/2026
4	Develop quality control metrics to track client sanctions.	07/01/2026

QUALITY IMPROVEMENT AND SUPPORT FOR CHILD CARE WORKFORCE:PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not have an annual requirement for a minimum number of hours of ongoing professional development for licensed family child care homes or license-exempt family child care homes, as required by 98.44(b)(2). (Plan Questions 6.3.1c and 6.3.1d)

Overall Target Completion Date: 07/01/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Draft new language for Iowa Administrative Code which updates ongoing training requirements for licensed family child care providers and licensed-exempt family child care providers from biennial to annual.	10/01/2025
2	Finalize Iowa Administrative Code to updated standards to annual ongoing training requirements.	07/01/2026
3	Update Standards and Procedure documents for licensed family child care (COMM 143) and licensed-exempt family child care (COMM 95) to reflect the updated annual ongoing training requirements.	07/01/2026
4	Update compliance checklist used by licensing inspectors to reflect the updated standards for	07/01/2026

	licensed family child care and license-exempt family child care.	
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